

# Blink — playtest sheet

RULES V0.24 · ONE SHEET PER GAME

players \_\_\_\_ date \_\_\_\_\_  
start \_\_\_\_\_ end \_\_\_\_\_

**Play the base game only.** No objectives module, no expansions — those are not tuned for these rules. The five questions below are the ones the design is actually stuck on; everything else can wait for the feedback form.

① **Free moves — the big unknown**

Each turn your band gives you 1–4 free moves (land across your own units, or sea). Tick roughly how many you actually used, and say what for.

|                                  |           |    |        |   |              |               |
|----------------------------------|-----------|----|--------|---|--------------|---------------|
| moves used per turn, typically   | none      | 1  | 2      | 3 | 4            | wanted more   |
| mostly used to...                | reinforce |    | escape |   | claim ground | didn't bother |
| did anyone forget they had them? | yes       | no |        |   |              |               |

② **Did the shape of a meld ever matter?**

Melds now only decide how many cards you spend. Straight of four and quadruple do the same work. Did anyone care which they held — and did anyone build toward a bigger meld on purpose?

|                                        |            |        |                   |
|----------------------------------------|------------|--------|-------------------|
| shape felt...                          | irrelevant | mildly | still interesting |
| anyone hold cards to build a big meld? | yes        | no     |                   |

③ **The cost of matching the winner — and how often you cashed**

Match the winner's card count and lose, and one card you played is set aside for 1 gold and goes to the shared pile; the meld that ranked last takes 1 gold. Tally one mark per card **you** cashed instead of using on the map (the sim predicts about one in three). Count for yourself only.

|                                                     |                                                                                          |                |                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------|
| cards cashed _____ of _____ played                  | · did cashing ever feel like the <i>obvious</i> choice, with no decision in it? yes / no |                |                                |
| did anyone ask how many cards they could use?       | yes                                                                                      | no             | (the rule exists to stop that) |
| giving up a card for matching the winner felt...    | a real cost                                                                              | barely noticed | too harsh                      |
| did anyone play FEWER cards on purpose to dodge it? | yes                                                                                      | no             |                                |
| the last-place coin felt...                         | welcome                                                                                  | pointless      | like charity                   |

④ **What ended the game, and did it land?**

The simulator says a suit's advanced deck always runs dry before anyone places a twentieth unit. If that happened, did the ending feel earned or abrupt?

|                    |                |                         |                          |
|--------------------|----------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| ended because...   | a suit ran out | someone placed 20 units |                          |
| the ending felt... | earned         | abrupt                  | nobody noticed it coming |

⑤ **Food and the coin shuffle**

Coins sit on your band's food slots and your people eat them at each recycle; you may move coins between reserve, food and fortifications freely on your turn.

|                                               |                |        |           |           |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------|--------|-----------|-----------|
| did anyone starve (return units)?             | yes, ___ times | never  |           |           |
| pre-placing food on the slots was...          | clear          | fiddly | forgotten | pointless |
| anyone pull coins off a fortification to eat? | yes            | no     |           |           |

Anything you had to look up, argue about, or invent

Best and worst moment

Scores — seat / total / population / victory row / dominance / gold left

would play again    1    2    3    4    5    ·    rules were clear    1    2    3    4    5

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Blink · v0.24 · playtest sheet · Toby Siko · the longer feedback form covers everything this page does not